

Before Installing MySQL

Before installing MySQL, it is important to judge if the current environment is conducive for the running of MySQL.

- **Compatibility of the current environment:** Not all the platforms are suitable to run MySQL. First, check for platform suitability.
- **Version of MySQL:** There are many versions of MySQL available and most of them are in distribution formats. To eliminate any doubt, use the most recent General Availability (GA) release and binary distribution.
- **Installing the distribution:** You can either install MySQL from binary distribution or from the source distribution.
- **Post installation setup:** After installing MySQL, perform the post installation setup such as creating a user account, and such.

It is also important for you to evaluate your environment to check if you require a fresh installation, upgradation or migration. Every platform has a separate set of instructions for download and installation.

You can get the latest versions and distributions of MySQL from the official MySQL website. Select the required version according to the platform and install it.

Installing MySQL

Depending on the platform and the requirement, there are various methods of installing MySQL in your system:

- **Installing on Unix/Linux using Generic Binaries**

To install using generic binaries, Oracle provides a set of binary distributions of MySQL in the form of compressed .tar files. These files have distributions for many platforms, and for platform-specific package formats.

The general procedure is as follows:

1. Create a group and user. Choose an organisation and a familiar name for the group and user. Use the commands `useradd` and `groupadd` to do this.
2. Download and unpack the distribution. When downloading, select your specific folder as the destination and then unpack the distribution.
3. Set up the permissions and accounts. After installing MySQL, set up the required permissions and create the required folders to start using MySQL.

- **Installing MySQL from Source**

When you install MySQL from source, you get immense flexibility to customise your code right from the installation location. But still, it is recommended to check if there is a pre-packaged distribution for your platform. Remember that adding too much non-standard customisation may reduce the performance.